

How do you learn? – Survey on digital learning & AI tools

I'm writing my bachelor's thesis on AI-based learning systems while building an app that brings the entire learning process into one place.

This survey helps me understand how students and professionals learn today, which tools they use and where the biggest frustrations are.

Takes about 5 minutes. Anonymous. Thank you! 🙏

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* Indicates required question

1. **1. How old are you? ***

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Under 18
- ☐ 18-22
- ☐ 23-26
- ☐ 27-30
- ☐ 30+

2. **2. What do you study/ in which field do you work? ***

3. **3. Which semester are you in? ***

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ 1-2
- ☐ 3-4
- ☐ 5-6
- ☐ 7+
- ☐ No longer a student/ Working professional

4. **4. Are you familiar with the term "Active Learning"? ***

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes, I know what it means.
- ☐ Roughly / I've heard of it.
- ☐ No.

5. **5. How would you describe your own learning style? ***

(**1 = very passive:** I mainly read or watch without processing/ **5 = very active:** I explain, summarize, solve problems, discuss)

1 2 3 4 5



6. 6. How do you mainly learn? **Check all that apply.*

- ☐ Reading lecture slides / scripts
- ☐ Watching Youtube/ explainer videos
- ☐ Writing notes
- ☐ Solving practice problems
- ☐ Explaining content to someone else
- ☐ Flashcards / quizzes
- ☐ Using AI tools
- ☐ Other: _____

7. 7. Which tools do you use for studying? **Check all that apply.*

- ☐ Notion / Obsidian
- ☐ GoodNotes / OneNote
- ☐ ChatGPT / Gemini / Claude / other AI
- ☐ Youtube
- ☐ NotebookLM
- ☐ Anki / Quizlet
- ☐ Other: _____

8. 8. How many different apps do you use on average per study session? **Mark only one oval.*

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2-3
- ☐ 4-5
- ☐ More than 5

9. **9. How disruptive do you find switching between different tools? ***

(1 = not disruptive at all / 5 = very disruptive)

1	2	3	4	5
☆	☆	☆	☆	☆

10. **10. What do you lose most when switching between tools? ***

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Concentration / flow
- ☐ Overview of my notes
- ☐ Context of the learning material
- ☐ Nothing, it doesn't bother me.

11. **11. How disruptive is it for you to re-upload your files and scripts every time you switch to a different AI tool? ***

(e.g. NotebookLM, ChatGPT, Claude, OneNote – starting from scratch every time)

(1 = doesn't bother me / 5 = very disruptive)

1	2	3	4	5
☆	☆	☆	☆	☆

12. **12. How much time do you estimate you lose per week rebuilding context across different apps** *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Barely / not at all
- ☐ 5 - 15 minutes
- ☐ 15 - 30 minutes
- ☐ More than 30 minutes

13. **13. How do you work with PDFs / scripts?** *

Check all that apply.

- ☐ I just read them passively.
- ☐ I highlight / annotate directly in the PDF / script.
- ☐ I write notes in parallel in a separate tool.
- ☐ I take photos and write notes separately.

14. **14. How do you check whether you've truly understood a topic** *

Check all that apply.

- ☐ I solve practice problems.
- ☐ I explain it to someone else.
- ☐ I write it out again.
- ☐ I test a test / use flashcards.
- ☐ Other: _____

15. **15. Do you feel that you've truly understood a topic when you can explain it to someone else in your own words?** *

(1 = no, not at all / 5 = yes, absolutely)

1 2 3 4 5



16. **16. How often do you get the chance to explain your learning material out loud or discuss it with someone?** *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often

17. **17. Would you prefer to explain learning content by speaking rather than typing?** *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe

18. **18. Do you use flashcards or spaced repetition for studying? ***

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes, actively with Anki or similar.
- ☐ Yes, but self-made on paper.
- ☐ Rarely.
- ☐ No.

19. **19. If flashcards were automatically generated from your own scripts – would you use that? ***

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe

20. **20. Would an AI chatbot be more useful if it answered exclusively based on your own scripts & notes – rather than the general internet ***

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes, definitely.
- ☐ Rather yes.
- ☐ Doesn't matter.
- ☐ Rather no.
- ☐ No.
- ☐ Would prefer a combination of both.

21. **21. Imagine an app that combines the following in one place:** *
- **Upload PDFs, write notes** – the AI chatbot instantly has context on your learning material, **no re-uploading across different platforms**

- An **AI chatbot** that knows your **own learning material** and can also **research external sources**

- An **AI** you **explain topics to in your own words** – that responds like a professor, peer, or child to **reveal gaps in your understanding**

- **Automatically generated flashcards** from your scripts

Would you use such an app?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes.
- ☐ Probably.
- ☐ Depends on the price.
- ☐ Probably not.
- ☐ No.

22. **22. What is your biggest frustration when studying – and what do you feel is missing from existing tools (e.g. ChatGPT, NotebookLM) to solve this problem?**

23. **23. Would you like to be one of the first to test the app? ***

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes, sign me up! *Skip to question 24*

☐ No, thanks.

Interested in the app?

Thanks a lot. I'll reach out as soon as the beta is ready. 🙌

24. **What's your email address? ***

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